January 2026 Harrison’s Hope New Website Content:

Home Page

Include: Our full logo & Slogan and Charity Registration Number and our embedded Donation Link and Donation QR Code

Harrison’s Hope

The journey is so much better, when we are not alone.

Charitable Registration No.
739239754 RR0001

Available for Mike’s USE for our Donation Link (would like on home page and strategically placed throughout:

CanadaHelps.org Profile URL for Harrison’s Hope

www.canadahelps.org/en/charities/harrisons-hope/

CanadaHelps.Org Harrison’s Hope Donation Form Link:

https://www.canadahelps.org/en/dn/130891

CanadaHelps.Org Donation Form Embedded Code:

<script id="ch_cdn_embed" type="text/javascript" src="https://www.canadahelps.org/secure/js/cdf_embed.2.js" charSet="utf-8" data-language="en" data-page-id="130891" data-root-url="https://www.canadahelps.org" data-formtype="0" data-cfasync="false"></script>

Next Section/TAB/Header

About Us

Content:

Copy for this Page:

Harrison's Hope is founded on the principle of lifelong support for individuals and families living with FASD. We recognize the need for a continuum of services that starts with prevention education and extends to senior care, fostering inclusion, dignity and interdependence.

Subheader: **Our People**

Our Founder

Mary Byrnes- Founder/Executive Director/ President of the Board of Harrison's Hope

Mary Byrnes is the Founder and Executive Director of Harrison's Hope, a Canadian charity dedicated to transforming the lives of individuals and families living with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD). Her advocacy began with the adoption of her son, a journey that led her to navigate the challenges of complex diagnoses, discover the power of FASD-informed support, and ultimately become a leading voice in the field.

With a background in early childhood education and special needs, Mary combines professional expertise with lived experience. Recently, she was diagnosed with Prenatal Alcohol Exposure herself, a milestone that has further shaped Harrison's Hope into a disability-led, caregiver- and lived-experience–informed organization.

Drawing from her dual lived and caregiver experience, Mary is recognized internationally as a passionate advocate, speaker, educator, and mentor for those living with FASD and professionals alike, sharing her story and insights across North America and the United Kingdom. She is committed to creating and advancing sustainable, disability-led, community-based supports across the lifespan, to ensure that every individual living with FASD and their caregivers have the opportunity to thrive.

Lisa Cohen – Director of Innovation & Program Design

Lisa C., MPA, is the Director of Innovation & Program Design at **Harrison's Hope**, where she specializes in designing services for individuals with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD) and their caregivers. With over 20 years in the developmental services sector, Lisa combines her professional leadership with her lived experience as a parent of a child with FASD. This unique perspective drives her commitment to creating empathetic, innovative programs and breaking down barriers to belonging. A Rick Hansen Foundation Accessibility Professional with a Master of Public Administration from Queen's University, Lisa has a proven track record in system redesign and financial oversight, dedicated to ensuring equitable access for the FASD community.

SUB HEADER: Our Board of Directors

Alex Antle – Board Chair

As Chief Operating Officer of a multinational CPG firm, **Alex Antle** has spearheaded a five-year strategic transformation resulting in over 200% growth in both revenue and EBITDA. His expertise spans Supply Chain, Go-to-Market strategy, and the integration of major acquisitions. Alex is passionate about mentoring start-ups and driving continuous improvement. He serves on the Board of Harrison's Hope, combining his deep corporate acumen with a personal commitment to the FASD community to ensure long-term organizational impact.

Amanda Roffey – Board Secretary

Amanda has been a Harrison's Hope Board Member since 2024. She holds a Business Administration - Marketing Diploma and post-secondary certification in Fundraising Management from Durham College. Amanda brings extensive experience in fundraising, marketing, public relations and event planning from the non-profit, education and healthcare sectors.

Michelle Musson – Board Treasurer

Michelle is a parent advocate and mentor with over 12 years of lived experience raising a child with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD). She has blogged about adoption and trauma-informed parenting through *Interwoven* and her own website, offering support and resources to families parenting children from hard places. Academically, Michelle holds 2 degrees with majors in Psychology and Human Resources. This, alongside her professional acumen in HR, volunteer, and program management, she brings both strategic and empathetic insight to her board role. Michelle is passionate about strengthening supports for individuals living with FASD and their families in order to see them thrive.

Alison Drenikow- Board Member At Large

Alison is a Kinship Carer of four, all suspected of living with FASD, ranging in ages from young child to young adults. She is a strong advocate for kinship care, add FASD advocacy in the community. She can most often be found at our tabling events and community events. As a past founder of a

charity organization, Alison shares her strong skill set in community partnership development and fundraising acumen with our organization. Alison is passionate about removing the stigma surrounding Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder by increasing community awareness and understanding.

SUBHEADER : Misson/ Vision/Core Values/Strategic Plan

Our Mission

Promote the dignity of individuals and families living with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD) by building safe, inclusive FASD informed communities that provide support throughout the lifespan of both individuals living with FASD and their caregivers across Canada.

Our Vision

At Harrison's Hope, we envision a world where individuals and families impacted by Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD) are empowered to thrive. Our commitment is to provide lifelong, knowledgeable support that respects the uniqueness of each person's journey, fosters strong community connections, and advocates for greater understanding and accessible resources.

Our Core Values

- Valuing Diversity
    - We strive to include experiences and resources from a wide range of individuals and caregivers affected by FASD. We are open about our limitations and acknowledge the possibility of unconscious bias due to privileged backgrounds. Our goal is to create an inclusive environment, recognizing and respecting diversity in all its forms.
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Children and Adults
    - Everyone has a responsibility to protect those most vulnerable. Our team makes the safety and well-being of individuals with FASD and their families a top priority, taking appropriate actions as needed throughout our work.
- Promoting Story Stewardship
    - Advocacy and education are rooted in people's stories. We share these stories only with explicit permission and ensure they are treated with utmost

respect. Privacy, confidentiality, and an individual's authority over their own experiences and medical histories are always honoured.

- Caring for the World and Its People
    - Our decisions consider environmental impacts, from program delivery and materials selection to partnerships. We are committed to working with organizations that practice sustainability and responsible stewardship.
- Prioritizing Collaboration
    - We believe in working with others, not for or to them. Excellence within the FASD community is recognized and celebrated. Power is shared, progress is celebrated, and the origins and authors of resources are always acknowledged.
- Amplifying the Quietest Voices
    - We are committed to listening attentively to those who feel under-represented, misheard, or misunderstood—especially caregivers and individuals across all ages and backgrounds affected by FASD. Their perspectives help guide our actions and advocacy.
- Offering Positive Alternatives
    - Solution-focused support is central to our approach. We provide FASD-informed services such as respite programs, family navigation, and skill-building opportunities. We embrace challenging problems and difficult conversations, always seeking constructive paths forward.
- Embracing Imperfection and Growth
    - We acknowledge that we are not perfect. Our organization welcomes feedback, strives for continuous improvement, and commits to doing our best until we know better. Harrison's Hope may be small, but our aspirations are ambitious and far-reaching.

Our Commitment

When you engage with Harrison's Hope, you can trust that our actions are shaped by these values. We are dedicated to fostering understanding, building community, and providing supportive resources that honour the lived experiences of every individual and family touched by FASD.

Harrison's Hope Strategic Plan

- Financials- remove
- Careers*-hide for now

Our Partnerships, Memberships and Collaborations Section

Canada FASD Research Network Member

Canada's source for evidence-based information on Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD)

- https://canfasd.ca/

FASD Knowledge Share Collective Member

The FASD Knowledge Share Collective is a n open space to share what you are doing in the field of FASD, discuss potential interests and ideas regarding recent developments in our states/territories/local areas, interstate , international, or cross-organizational collaborations, and any other ideas for sharing what has or hasn't worked , challenges we've experienced , and how we can learn from one another. The intention is to promote immediate networking and successful connections that can then be furthered through individual collaborations after or in-between Knowledge Share meetings.

- https://fasdunited.org/event/fasd-knowledge-share-collective-2/

FASD Collaborative Project Member

FASD Collaborative Project is focused on supporting the creation of fully inclusive communities that address the needs of all individuals who are neurodiverse, which includes extremely underserved populations like the FASD community. Currently, we provide access to support groups, online webinars, and special interest groups.
https://www.fasdcollaborative.com/

Accessibility Partner Network (Rick Hansen) Member

The Accessibility Professional Network is a membership network created to bring together accessibility professionals including RHFAC Professionals, accessibility consultants, experts in

the built environment, students passionate about access and anyone interested in creating a Canada that's accessible for all.
Join the Accessibility Professional Network | Rick Hansen Foundation

Toronto Accelerating Accessibility Coalition Member
The AAC is comprised of local and national organizations as well as individual volunteers listed below who have signalled their commitment to the AAC's vision: for people of all ages and abilities in Canada to have access to homes that are free of barriers and support their ability to participate fully in society
Membership | ULI Toronto

Toronto Jewish Disability Network Member
Connecting those with lived experience, families, caregivers, professionals, leaders and community.
Toronto Jewish Disability Network

Intentional Community Consortium Member
The Intentional Community Consortium (ICC), founded in 2017, is a registered not-forprofit, representing charities and not-for-profit organizations, working to solve the housing crisis for those with developmental disabilities across Canada by: Using scale and shared learning from our member organizations, Expanding affordable housing projects for mixed use with a preference to build multiunit projects of 20-units or more , Combining the strength of our member organizations resulting in creating hundreds of housing units throughout Canada, and Creating a consortium advocacy approach to all levels of Government.
(4) Intentional Community Consortium: Posts | LinkedIn

Prevention Network Action Team Member on FASD Prevention (pNAT) from a Women's Health Determinants' Perspective (pNAT) is a group of people from all regions of Canada that meet monthly to talk about research, policy, and practice related to FASD prevention and healthy beginnings. Our members include researchers, service providers, policy advisors, community based activists and women with lived experience.
https://cewh.ca/current-projects/women-alcohol-and-fasd-prevention/

Markham Stouffville Hospital Community Mental Health Approved Resource Partner
We are listed with the Markham Stouffville Hospital Approved Mental Health Resource Parters as an FASD Resource Provider.
https://www.oakvalleyhealth.ca/clinics-departments/mental-health/mental-health-adult-outpatient-services/

Drug Abuse Resistance Education. Canada (D.A.R.E. Canada)- Committee Member/Community Partner
D.A.R.E. is a police officer-led series of classroom lessons that teaches children from kindergarten through 12th grade how to resist peer pressure and live productive drug and violence-free lives.
https://dare.org/canada/

Current Research Partnerships

1. Accessibility Standards Canada Expression Of Interest
2. AI/App Development with Dr. Mansfield Mela

Collaborative Partners

- **Association of Native Child and Family Service Agencies of Ontario**
  www.ancfsao.ca

- **Interwoven Connections**
  https://interwovenconnections.ca/

- **UNIVERSITY OF ALBERTA**
  College of Social Sciences and Humanities Faculty of Education

https://www.ualberta.ca/en/education/index.html

- **University of Calgary**
  Faculty of Social Work
  https://socialwork.ucalgary.ca/

- **Autism Alliance of Canada | Alliance canadienne de l'autisme**
  https://autismalliance.ca/

- **SenseTech Solutions Inc.**
  https://sensetech.ca/

- **Developing And Nurturing Independence (DANI Toronto)**
  - https://www.dani-toronto.com/
- **Ella**
  - Ella | AI-Powered Visual Learning Tools for Neurodiverse Children

- **York Region North Partnership Table**
- **And more...**

Add a button for "Call for Partnerships" Something people can click on if they want to invite us to partner on research; etc?

- Add our Donate Link at bottom of this section
- Contact Us – add at the bottom of this section

Testimonials - across bottom of all pages OR separate tab completely

Next Section/TAB/PAGE

Our Services

This SECTION to include drop downs for the following:

Caregiver Supports/ Services for Individuals Living with FASD/Services for Agencies, Organizations, Schools and Other Institutions

Caregiver Supports

- Service Navigation
    - Supporting caregivers through the understanding of services and supports available in their communities, and from other professionals
- Peer to Peer Caregiver Support Programs
    - Free Twice Weekly Virtual Caregiver Support Groups moderated by experienced fellow caregivers
- Virtual Special Guest Speaker Series
    - Free Monthly Virtual Guest Speakers share their area of expertise in topics that support individuals living with FASD and their caregivers
- Respite Programs
    - 8 Week Programs where Individuals living with FASD develop life skills, social skills fully supported by FASD Informed staff, while enjoying time in their communities with others. Committed time for caregivers to rest, recover and rejuvenate
    - See Calendar of Events for Current Respite Program Offerings
- Caregiver Workshops & Conferences
    - Customized Workshops and Conferences with content developed focused for Caregivers and their loved ones with topics covering the lifespan of both. Latest research and date-driven information offers families a path forward for today and for the future.
- Resource Library
    - Include all content from the Resource Page here
- FAQ's *
- *Future: Live Chat**

Services for Individuals Living with FASD

- Service Navigation

    - Supporting individuals living with FASD, through the understanding of services and supports available in their communities, and from other professionals
- Peer to Peer Youth & Adult Support Programs *coming soon
- Youth Transitioning to Adulthood Mentorship Programs *coming soon
- Lived Experience FASD Conference *coming soon
- Resource Library
    - Include all content from the Resource Page here
- FAQ's *
- *Future: Live Chat**

Services for Agencies & Other Organizations

Consultations, Collaborations, Partnerships and Committee Advisories

- Consultation and collaboration is available to service providers, programs, organizations and schools.
- We have provided many consultations to various groups, school boards, not for profits, foster & adoption agencies, volunteer organizations and more.

Our Harrison's Hope Customized Training Offerings

We offer three levels of training packages to accommodate the length of time available, number of delegates, context and learning aspirations for service providers, agencies, and institutions seeking FASD knowledge growth, enabling their staffing to operate from a real-world FASD-informed lens.

Plenary Speech -> Workshop

20 minutes -> 2 hours

Deliver a **keynote** of **workshop** centring on the values of FASD-informed communication, co-production, and collaborative working to enhance understanding and support for individuals affected by Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder.

From $950 CAN

Find Out More

In the past we have spoken at:

- International and national conferences (FASD Success **Caregiver Conference**, Association of Native Child and Family Service Agencies of Ontario **Indigenous Child & Family Wellbeing Conference,** FASD United International FASD Conference, **National Neurodiversity Celebration Week** Conference, Lexxis UK and more)
- Mental Health & Wellness Events
- Anti-Human Trafficking Events

Team Training

Half -> One day

As part of a **conference or team training day**, our courses can nurture FASD-informed empathic working by creating a shared language and understanding of different perspectives related to Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder. With time to reflect, an action plan is created and personalized report provided.

From $2,800 CAD

Find Out More

In the past, we have delivered

- Organization training days to High School Special Education Resource Staff
- Child & Youth Mental Health Care Staff
- Mental Health Care Resource Teams
  Children's Aid Society Multi-department staff and Carers (Foster/ Adopt Ready/Kinship)
- Youth Restorative Justice Front-Line Staff
- Residential Care Home Front-Line Staff
- And more

System/Organization-Wide Service Improvement Package

A three-phase co-produced improvement project tailored to your organization's bespoke needs with lived experience embedded throughout.

From $9000 CAN

Read More

This unique offer starts with consultancy, uses the perspective of local people with lived experience of Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder and professionals to co-produce solutions specific to your context. Designed to improve systems, communication, and outcomes for people accessing your services through an FASD-informed approach.

Phases:

1. **Listening to Lived Experience**
    - Consultancy day working with practitioners in their own environment and listening to needs/challenges related to supporting persons living with FASD
    - Online workshop and digital questionnaire to gather feedback from people living with FASD using your services
2. **Training and Action Plan Workshop**
    - 1-day in-person workshop with key stakeholders (including paid lived experience representatives)
3. **Service Improvement Report**
    - A detailed, actionable report outlining real-world solutions and recommendations created.

We are passionate about our work and the transformation it brings and often work to **different budgets and needs**.

Please get in touch if have an event, training need or organizational aspiration you think we can support and we will do our best to accommodate your specific learning requirements, aspirations or budgets.

Next Section/TAB/PAGE (this is the only section that needs to be set up so that we can continually add content on our own- and allow people to REGISTER for the posted events online- either through the use of our Zeffy Account links or other free manner)

Attend an Event (Calendar)*

Under the events page, please add "News and Coming Soon Events" so when we have something new on the horizon, there's a section we can share it in.

Also please include the following EVERY WEEK except between Christmas and New Years: Our Free Virtual FASD Caregiver Support Groups

Harrison's Hope FASD Caregiver Support Groups:

Free Virtual Zoom Meeting for Every Tuesday Evening (8-9pm EST) Harrison's Hope FASD Caregiver Support Group

And
Free Virtual Zoom Meeting for Every Thursday Afternoon (1-2pm EST) Harrison's Hope FASD Caregiver Support Group

January Events:

Date	Content	Image

Jan. 13 evening	Special Guest Speaker: Nate Sheets	Harrison's Hope **Join Harrison's Hope for a FREE Virtual Evening with our Special Guest Speaker*: Nate Sheets*** **on: Tuesday January 13th, 2026 @ 8-9:30pm EST** **Nate Sheets, Behaviour Consultant, Author and Speaker and Sought After FASD Expert!!** **About Nate:** **Nate Sheets is a behavior consultant and parent coach supporting children and adults with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorders (FASDs) for over 17 years. He has worked extensively with families, foster providers, schools, and programs to implement practical, brain-based strategies that help people with FASDs be successful and thrive. His book, "Essential FASD Supports" was published in 2023. You can learn more about Nate at www.cogsupports.com.** **Register by emailing: Info@harrisonshope.ca**

February Events:

Date	Content	Image
Feb evening	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: Antonia Rathbun Lindsey (France)	Harrison's Hope **Join Harrison's Hope for a FREE Virtual Afternoon with our Special Guest Speaker*: Antonia Rayburn Lindsey*** **on: Wednesday February 4th, 2026 @ 2 to 3:30pm EST** **Antonia Rayburn Lindsey is a Therapist, Author and Speaker and Sought After FASD Expert!!** **About Antonia:** **Antonia is an art therapist, child and family therapist, and credentialed disabilities specialist whose professional and lived expertise informs her new guidebook, Parenting Your Porcupine: A Toolkit for Children with FASD, Other Drug Effects & Neurodiversity. Drawing on decades of work with families and children impacted by FASD and other neurodiversity, Antonia offers practical, compassionate tools that bridge the gap between science and daily life.** **Register by emailing: Info@HarrisonsHope.ca**

Feb 7th or 8th (Sun)	Snow tubing- Horseshoe Valley	

March Events:

Date	Content	Image
Mar 17th 5:00 PM – 6:30 PM GMT	"FASD & Employment Success" - International Panel Discussion with Maggie McHugh, Nyrene Cox, Jane Pickersgill, Andrew Keeping, Velma Eyre	
Mar 31st Evening	Virtual Special Guest Speaker – Tanya Eichler- Polyvagal Theory & FASD	

April Events:

Date	Content	Image
Apr 28th evening	Virtual Special Guest Speaker – Joey Klein-Indigenous Artist living with FASD	
Sundays - April 12 to Jun 7th	"The Wave Makers" 8 Week Respite Club - Swim & fun times together. Location: Barrie/Orillia	
April Evening Date TBD	Bingo Night & BINGO World, 350 Newkirk Rd, Richmond Hill- 905-884-7795 www.rhhca.ca	

May Events:

Date	Content	Image
May26th	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: Sylvia Gibbons- ACO & NTL- Pathway to Permanency Session Date: May 26 evening	

May 3rd, 2026	All Ages Pizza & Paint Afternoon From 1pm to 4pm EST Location: Poppi's Italian Restaurant 122 Ramillies, Rd, Borden, ON (at Camp Borden)	

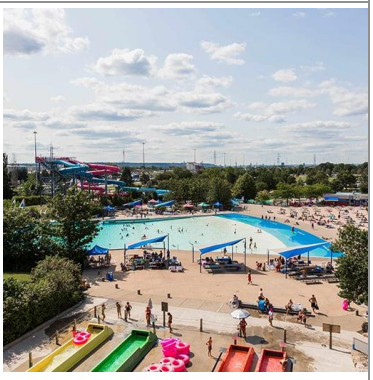
June Events:

Date	Content	Image
Jun ??	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: Courtney & Natascha 1 hr & 30 minute Q&A - The Indigenous Experience $??	
Jun 7th	"The Wave Makers" 8 Week Respite Club - Swim & fun times together. Location:	

July Events:

Date	Content	Image
July – early in month	Berry Picking Afternoon- Barrie Hills Farm Barrie Hill Farms 2935 Barrie Hill Rd. Springwater, ON L9X 1S8 (705) 728-0571	

August Events:

Date	Content	Image
Aug – Sunday afternoon or mid week	Wild Water Works $4.75 each/ Support Person or Parent free **Wild Waterworks** 680 Van Wagners Beach Road Hamilton, ON, L8E 3L8	
Aug date to be determined	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: Joanne Garfello- FASD & Music	

September Events:

Date	Content	Image
Sept. 1, 2024	September is Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD) month! Join #harrisonshope in raising awareness of FASD and learn how your family can achieve peaceful days at home, school and in the community.	

Sept 6th	Join us on September 6th from 1:00 – 4:00 p.m. in Barrie, Ontario for a FASD Walk, Run or Roll. Bring the children and family and help us to increase awareness of FASD. Visit harrisonshope.ca to learn more about FASD and how we can help you and your family. #FASD, #harrisonshope	
Sept 9	We're raising awareness of FASD today! Thank you to everyone who came out to support individuals and families living with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder.	
	As a growing registered charity, we rely on the generosity of individuals, company sponsorship and corporate support, to ensure we can continue to raise awareness of FASD and support the families living with FASD, across Canada. Make an impact today with online donation: harrisons-hope | CharityProfile | Donate Online or Scan the QR Code #FASD, #HarrisonsHope	

Sept 11	Harrison's Hope provides 1-2-1 sessions with parents and caregivers, our caregiver support groups, agency consultations and FASD support trainings. Visit www.harrisonshope.ca to learn more.	
Sept ??	Virtual Special Guest: Amanda Burley- Life After High School	
Sunday Sept ??	Harrison's Hope Fall Family Gathering: Apple Orchard Visit **Address:** 2935 Barrie Hill Rd, Springwater, ON L9X 1S8 A Sunday afternoon in the Apple Orchard **Phone:** (705) 728-0571	
Sept 21	In honour of FASD Awareness Month, consider donating to Harrison's Hope so we can continue providing supportive workshops and resources for individuals and families living with Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD). Make an impact today with online donation: harrisons-hope | CharityProfile | Donate Online or Scan the QR Code Thank you for your support!	

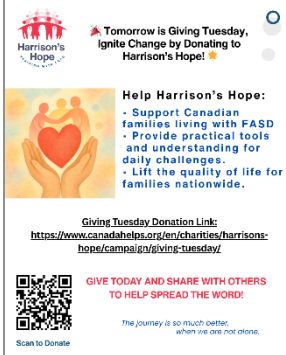
October Events:

Date	Content	Image
Sunday Oct ??	Pet Therapy Day – Lions Club Dog Guides??	
Oct	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: Carl Young? Raising My Children living with FASD?? Aging with FASD	

November Events:

Date	Content	Image
Nov 1st?	Bond Over Bowling- Newmarket Stellar Lanes	
Mid Nov	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: ??	

December Events:

Date	Content	Image
Dec 2	**Giving Tuesday:**	

Dec	**Give the Gift of Hope:** Donate to Harrison's Hope so our team can provide safe spaces and tailored interventions to support families living with FASD. By focusing on strengths, we will empower individuals to thrive.	
	Virtual Special Guest Speaker: Shannon Butt- Adult with Living Experience- Shares Her Story	

-
- Fundraising Events (Calendar)*
    - Pull Out for Event Calendar above**

Include Photos of Past Events using shared link Mary emailed to you to access Harrison's Hope Event photos on our Sharepoint Site:

Next Section/TAB/PAGE

Resources

Sub Header:

Recommended Reading

Books:

- Raising Kids and Teens with FASD by Barb Clark
- Essential FASD Supports: Understanding & Supporting People with FASD by Nate Sheets

- Embracing Zak by Jodee Kulp
- Embracing Hope by Carl Young & Joel Sheagren
- Fetal Alcohol/Neurobehavioral Conditions: Understanding and Application of a Brain-Based Approach, by Diane Malbin
- Trying Differently Rather Than Harder, by Diane Malbin and updated version by Lynn Alsup, et al
- Smart but Scattered TEENS by Richard Guare, Peg Dawson & Colin Guare
- Smart but Scattered and Stalled by Richard Guare, Peg Dawson & Colin Guare
- Parenting Your Porcupine by Antonia Rathburn Lindsey

Sub Header:

Recommended Websites

Embedded Links to these FASD Resource Websites:

- **CanFASD** **https://canfasd.ca/**
- **FASD Ontario** **https://www.fasdinfotsaf.ca/resources-library/**
- **FASD Collaborative** **https://www.fasdcollaborative.com/**
- Parenting Your Porcupine by Antonia Rathburn Lindsey

Sub Header:

Recommended FASD Resource Websites

- **Amaze** **https://amaze.org/**
- **Ella** Ella | AI-Powered Visual Learning Tools for Neurodiverse Children
- **FASD Evaluation** https://fasd-evaluation.ca/co-creating-evidence-resource-documents.html

Sub Header:

Recommended FASD Journal Articles

- Sex, gender and alcohol: implications for males, men and the communication of risk (2024)
- Supporting pregnant and parenting women who use alcohol during pregnancy: A scoping review of trauma-informed approaches (2023)
- Sex, Gender, and Alcohol Use: Implications for Women and Low-Risk Drinking Guidelines (2022)
- "The Problem Is that We Hear a Bit of Everything . . . ": A Qualitative Systematic Review of Factors Associated with Alcohol Use, Reduction, and Abstinence in Pregnancy (2021)

- What Both Sexes and All Genders Need to Know About Lower Risk Drinking (2025) – Op-ed written by our Senior Investigator, Dr. Lorraine Greaves, on the sex and gender impacts of alcohol and implications for lower risk drinking

- Canada's Guidance on Alcohol and Health (2023) – Our team was involved with the Canadian Centre on Substance Use and Addiction's evidence review and guideline creation, offering expertise on evaluating sex and gender related factors impacting alcohol use and risks, as well as risks to reproductive and perinatal health.
- Healthy Care Pregnancy Program Evaluation 2020-2022 – We conducted an evaluation of the BC Association of Pregnancy Outreach Programs'

pilot which supports pregnant, postpartum, and new parents who use or have used substances in BC.

- Co-Creating Evidence Evaluation Project (2017-2020) – Conducted in collaboration with Nota Bene Consulting Group, this was a multi-site evaluation of 8 community-based programs across Canada that support women with substance use and complex issues through harm reduction, trauma-informed, culturally safe, and women-centred wraparound approaches:
    - A Mustard Seed of Hope: Culturally grounded approaches within wraparound care for pregnant and parenting women dealing with substance use and trauma
    - Digital handbook on wraparound programs – English or French

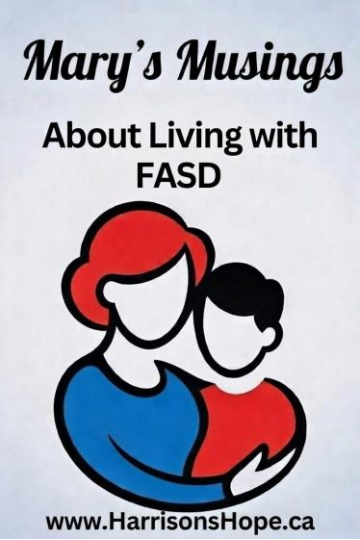
Sub Header:

Harrison's Hope Webinars & Talks

- **Mary gave Mike Access to the folder in Sharepoint that houses these to upload for viewing only**

Sub Header:

"Mary's Musings About Living with FASD"



Weekly Blog **coming soon (we need to set this up so we can launch all the content I have ready to go)

Sub Header:

Harrison's Hope YouTube Channel **coming soon (we already have: Harrisons_Hope_FASD)

Include link- that needs to be set up

Sub Header:

Harrison's Hope Podcast Links ***Launching Spring 2026

Next Section/TAB/PAGE

Get Involved

Sub Header:

Volunteer

Join the Team at Harrison's Hope

At **Harrison's Hope**, we support people and families living with FASD (Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder). We believe that no one should have to walk this path alone. By giving your time, you help us build a community where everyone belongs.

How You Can Make a Difference

We have many ways for you to get involved and help our mission grow:

- **Event Support:** Help us plan and run our community walks and family fun days.
- **Support Groups:** Assist our leaders in creating a kind and safe space for families to meet.
- **Office Help:** Use your skills to help us share news and stay organized.
- **Awareness:** Help us teach others about FASD so our community can be more helpful and fair.

Why Volunteer with Us?

- **Professional Growth:** Gain experience in the non-profit sector and build new skills.
- **Community Connection:** Meet dedicated people who care about making a positive change.
- **Lasting Impact:** Your work directly helps families find the resources and friendship they need.

Join Our Mission Today

We are looking for kind, reliable people to join our team. Whether you can help for one hour or one day a week, we would love to have you.

"Together, we can build a future full of hope and understanding."

[Fill Out a Volunteer Application]

- **https://forms.office.com/pages/responsepage.aspx?id=DQSIkWdsW0yxEjajBLZtrQAAAAAAAAAAAAO__So-8xVUQkRNVDUwUzBOSFdYVDFZWlpJVUVXV1FUVy4u&route=shorturl**
- **Mary give Mike Access in SharePoint to find our Volunteer Form that Michelle Musson has created- link is shared above**

Sub Header:

Fundraise for Us

Support the Mission of Harrison's Hope

At **Harrison's Hope**, we help families living with FASD. We want every person to feel supported and strong. To do this, we need to raise money for our programs. Your help with **fundraising** ensures that no family has to face their journey alone.

Ways You Can Help Raise Funds

There are many great ways to help us reach our goals:

- **Host an Event:** You can organize a bake sale, a car wash, or a fun run with your friends.
- **Online Giving:** Share our page on the computer so your family and friends can donate.
- **Corporate Gifts:** Ask a local business to support our mission with a gift.
- **Special Projects:** Help us collect items for our community auctions and raffles.

Why Your Help Matters

- **Provide Resources:** The money you raise pays for helpful tools and classes for parents.
- **Create Fun Memories:** Donations help us host parties and events for kids and families.
- **Spread Hope:** Every dollar helps us tell more people about FASD and how to be kind.

Start Your Fundraising Goal Today

Raising money is a powerful way to show you care. Whether you raise a little or a lot, every bit makes a big difference for Harrison's Hope.

"When we work together, we can change lives and build a brighter future."

[Start a Fundraiser Today]

Need online form created

Next Section/TAB/PAGE

Donate

Sub Header:

Give The Gift of Hope

At **Harrison's Hope**, we work hard to support families living with FASD. We want every person to have the help they need to succeed. When you **donate**, your gift provides the tools and care that make a real difference in our community.

Your Donation Makes an Impact

Your kindness helps us provide important services for families. Here is how your gift helps:

- **Family Support:** Your money helps us run groups where parents can meet and support each other.
- **Learning Tools, Programs and Services:** Donations help us create inclusive resources and programs that educate, reduce stigma, and support sustainable communities.

Community Events: Your donation funds family activities and events.

- **Safe Spaces:** Donations help us keep our doors open so families always have a place to go for help.

Why Your Gift Matters

- **You Provide Hope:** Your support shows families that they are not alone.
- **You Create Change:** Every dollar helps us build a community that is kind and fair to everyone.
- **You Build a Future:** Your contribution can make a tangible difference in the lives of local families by providing critical services and hope.

Send Your Gift Today

Making a donation is a powerful way to show you care. Whether your gift is small or large, it helps Harrison's Hope reach more families in need.

"A single gift can light the way for a family in need of hope."

[Make a Donation Now]

Donate easily via CanadaHelps.org
Click Here to Donate!
OR
Scan the QR Code to donate online
via the CanadaHelps.org website

Ways to Give to Harrison's Hope

There are two special ways you can send a gift to help our families. Both ways help us make sure no one has to walk their journey alone.

1. Monthly Giving: The Best Way to Help

A monthly gift is a small amount of money you send every month. It is like a subscription to kindness!

- **How it helps:** It gives Harrison's Hope a steady hand. We can plan more fun events and buy more tools because we know your help is coming.
- **Why it's great:** You can give a small amount, like $10 or $20, and it adds up to a huge help by the end of the year!

2. Tribute Giving: A Gift in Someone's Name

A tribute gift is a way to honour someone special. You can give a gift to celebrate a happy day or to remember someone you love.

- **In Celebration:** Give a gift for a birthday, a wedding, or a holiday. It is a wonderful way to say "I care about you!"
- **In Memory:** Give a gift to remember a loved one who has passed away. It turns a sad time into a way to help others.
- **How it helps:** We will send a special card to let the person (or their family) know that a kind gift was made in their name.

Every Gift Builds a Brighter Future

Whether you give every month or give a gift for a friend, you are a hero to the families at Harrison's Hope.

"Your kindness is a light that helps families find their way."

[Choose Your Way to Give Today]

Sub Header:

Why Give?

Our Impact: Thriving with FASD

At Harrison's Hope, we believe the journey is so much better when we are not alone. Since our inception on **May 6, 2024**, we have moved rapidly from vision to action, building a lifeline of support for Canadian families navigating the complexities of Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD).

2024–2025: A Year of Remarkable Growth

In just over a year, we have expanded our reach to ensure that every caregiver has the resources, advocacy, and community they need to help their loved ones thrive.

Direct Family & Caregiver Support

- **100+ Caregivers Supported:** Providing a foundation of hope and expertise since our inception.
- **48 Families Served:** Delivering direct support and specialized services to help families navigate their unique paths.
- **100% Success in School Advocacy:** Successfully supported **3 families** in securing critical **IPRC identifications and IEPs**, ensuring children receive the specialized educational placements and support they deserve.

Virtual Support Groups: Breaking the Isolation

We have dramatically scaled our support networks to meet the growing need for connection:

- **2024:** 65 Virtual Caregiver Support Groups provided for **76 caregivers**.
- **2025:** 96 Virtual Caregiver Support Groups reached **298 caregivers**—a nearly **300% increase** in community engagement.

Education & Expert Advocacy

- **Guest Speaker Series:** Launched in January 2025, our monthly virtual series hosted **168 attendees**, bringing international experts directly to our community.
- **High-Impact Webinars:** Partnered with 2 key community organizations to host **3 specialized webinars**. Our session geared toward caregivers and service partners set an agency record with **54 virtual attendees**.

- **Digital Community:** Our private Facebook group for FASD Caregivers & Experts has grown to **57 active members**, including world-renowned adults living with FASD, mentors, coaches, and educators.

Why It Matters

Isolation is a primary contributor to mental health vulnerability in FASD caregivers. By providing a "lighthouse" through support groups and advocacy, Harrison's Hope is disrupting this pattern. We aren't just sharing information; we are crafting a seamless tapestry of care, knowledge, and advocacy that creates sustainable change for neurodivergent families.

"Empowering Canadian families living with FASD to thrive, sustainably, in the community."

[Button: Support Our Mission – Donate Today] [Button: Join Our Community]

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Sub Header:

Family Stories

From Crisis to Connection: Leo's Story

When Leo went missing, his parents, Sarah and Mark, didn't just feel fear—they felt a profound sense of helplessness. Like many youth living with **Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorder (FASD)**, Leo's challenges with impulsivity and social cues made him an easy target for predators.

By the time the authorities realized Leo had been scouted by a local sex-trafficking ring, he was already miles from home, disconnected from his support system, and trapped in a cycle of exploitation.

How Harrison's Hope Stepped In

Standard intervention often fails youth with FASD because it doesn't account for their unique brain-based needs. Our team jumped into action as soon as Leo's parents reached out to us; we acted as the **bridge between the family, and the trusted experts of a local anti-sex trafficking organization** Leo required.

- **Expert Advocacy:** We worked directly with the anti-sex trafficking organization to explain Leo's neurodiversity, ensuring they approached him with the de-escalation techniques necessary for someone with FASD.
- **Rapid Response:** While the family was paralyzed by grief, our local partners to tracked the grooming patterns common in these rings.
- **Safe Return:** Within 72 hours, Leo was located. Our team was there to facilitate a trauma-informed transition back to his caregivers, preventing the further "shutdown" that often occurs during high-stress rescues.

The Impact

Today, Leo is back in a stabilized home environment. Because of Harrison's Hope, Sarah and Mark have a dedicated "Safety Roadmap" to prevent future exploitation, and Leo has a community that understands his brain, protects his vulnerability, and celebrates his strengths.

"Without Harrison's Hope, we wouldn't have known where to turn. They didn't just help bring our son home; they gave us the tools to keep him safe." — *Sarah, Leo's Mom*

Why FASD Support Matters

Youth with FASD are disproportionately vulnerable to exploitation. Our mission is to ensure that no child falls through the cracks and no family has to face the unthinkable alone.

Breaking the Cycle: Maya's Journey to an IEP

For two years, Maya's parents, David and Elena, felt like they were shouting into a void. Their daughter was bright and creative, but in her Grade 3 classroom, she was struggling. Maya was frequently sent to the office for "non-compliance" and "disruptive outbursts."

Despite her FASD diagnosis, the school board repeatedly denied Maya an **Identification, Placement, and Review Committee (IPRC)** meeting. They claimed her academic scores were "too high" for specialized support, ignoring the profound social and emotional dysregulation that made her school day a battleground.

The Turning Point

Exhausted and defeated, the family reached out to Harrison's Hope. Our team stepped in to shift the narrative from "behavioral issues" to **"neuro-diverse needs."**

- **Clinical Translation:** We gathered Maya's medical history and translated clinical FASD data into "classroom-ready" language that demonstrated exactly why she was struggling.
- **The Advocacy Advantage:** Our team joined David and Elena at the negotiation table. We leveraged provincial education standards to prove that Maya's FASD met the criteria for a "Communication: Learning Disability" and a "Multiple" designation.
- **FASD-Informed Accommodations:** We didn't just ask for a plan; we helped design it. We secured specific accommodations, including sensory breaks, visual schedules, and a "first-then" instruction model tailored to her processing speed.

A New Chapter for Maya

Within three months of Harrison's Hope joining the team, Maya was formally identified by the IPRC. Today, she has a robust **Individual Education Plan (IEP)** that supports her brain rather than punishing it.

The office visits have stopped. Maya is finally learning in an environment that understands her, and for the first time in two years, she told her parents, *"I'm actually good at school."*

"Harrison's Hope changed the trajectory of Maya's life. They gave us the expertise we needed to make the school see our daughter for who she truly is—a student with potential, not a problem to be solved." — *David, Maya's Father*

Every Child Deserves to Belong

In Ontario, navigating the school system with FASD can be an uphill battle. We ensure families don't have to climb it alone.

Justice Through Understanding: Marcus's Path Forward

By age 20, Marcus had been through the court system three times for minor, non-violent offenses. To the legal system, Marcus looked like a "repeat offender" who refused to follow court orders. To his family, Marcus was a young man with **FASD** whose memory deficits and poor impulse control made it physically impossible for him to comply with standard probation terms.

Marcus was facing significant jail time for "failing to comply"—essentially being punished for the symptoms of his brain injury.

The Harrison's Hope Intervention

When Marcus's family reached out, he was weeks away from sentencing. Our team acted quickly to provide a **"FASD Informed Justice Defense"** strategy that changed the courtroom dynamic.

- **The FASD Impact Statement:** We prepared a comprehensive report for Marcus's lawyer and the Crown, explaining how his prenatal alcohol exposure affected his "executive functioning"—specifically his ability to link cause and effect and remember future appointments.
- **Reframing "Defiance" as "Disability":** We educated the court on why traditional probation (like "reporting every Monday") was a setup for failure for Marcus, and proposed a modified approach.
- **A Plan for Success:** Instead of jail, we advocated for a diversion program that included a "Success Coach" from Harrison's Hope to help Marcus manage his schedule and sensory needs.

A Fairer Outcome

The judge accepted the Harrison's Hope recommendations. Instead of a custodial sentence that would have likely led to further trauma and recidivism, Marcus was granted a conditional discharge with FASD-specific supports.

Today, Marcus isn't behind bars; he is working part-time with a job coach and has not had a single legal "run-in" in over a year. He is finally being supported as a person with a disability, rather than a criminal.

"The justice system is built for people who can remember rules and consequences. Marcus can't do that. Harrison's Hope was the only voice in the room that actually understood his brain, and they quite literally saved his future." — *Marcus's Family*

Advocacy Beyond the Courtroom

We believe that justice is only served when a person's disability is understood. We work tirelessly to educate judges, lawyers, and police services to ensure the law works *for* our community, not against it.

Sub Header:

Community Engagement Highlights

At **Harrison's Hope**, we believe that the journey is better when we are not alone. Our commitment to creating FASD-informed communities is reflected in our active engagement with educational institutions, healthcare providers, and provincial partners. Below are the milestones and highlights of our recent community outreach and advocacy efforts.

Educational Advocacy & Student Support

We are dedicated to fostering inclusive environments where students living with FASD can thrive.

- **Empowering Educators:** Following a special request, Harrison's Hope provided specialized training on **"How to Support Students Living with FASD"** for the staff and administration at **Keswick High School**.
- **Investing in Futures:** We are proud to have championed **two new annual Harrison's Hope Graduate Bursaries** for students at Keswick High School, supporting the next generation as they transition to post-secondary success.

Healthcare & Clinical Partnerships

By integrating FASD knowledge into clinical settings, we ensure families receive the specialized navigation they deserve.

- **Hospital Registry Integration:** Harrison's Hope has been officially added to the **Markham Stouffville Hospital Service Provider Registry** for Child Psychiatry Service Navigators.
- **Raising Clinical Awareness:** We were invited by Markham Stouffville Hospital to lead an information session for a broad spectrum of professionals—including pediatric units, Child Life Specialists, and Social Workers—to expand the reach of FASD-informed care across the hospital.
- **Community Presence:** We actively participated in the **October Mental Health Fair** at Markham Stouffville Hospital, connecting directly with families and healthcare providers.

Provincial & Indigenous Collaboration

Our advocacy extends to provincial networks and Indigenous child and family welfare organizations to ensure systemic change.

- **Systemic Prevention:** Our founder, Mary, was invited to join the **Prevention Network Action Team (pNAT)**, contributing to provincial strategies on FASD Prevention.
- **Protecting the Vulnerable:** We participated in the **3rd Annual York Region Anti-Human Trafficking Conference** at Seneca Polytechnic, a critical 2-day event funded by the Department of Justice Canada.
- **Training & Capacity Building:**

- Delivered a **Training Webinar for the York Region Children's Aid Society**, reaching 25 staff and caregivers across all divisions.
- Presented two **2-hour FASD Workshops** at the **Indigenous Child and Family Wellbeing Conference** (December 2025).
- Following the success of these workshops, we presented at the **Association of Native Child and Family Service Agencies of Ontario Learning Circle** in January 2026.

Our Digital Community Reach

The "Harrison's Hope" message is resonating across Canada. Our digital footprint continues to grow, providing a "Community Compass" for those in need:

- **Facebook:** 334 Followers (with over **635,000 views** in the last 90 days).
- **Instagram:** 2,700 Followers (averaging **3,000+ views** per post and reel).
- **LinkedIn:** 772 Followers and 500+ professional connections, generating over **10,000 impressions**.
- **Total Reach:** Over **3,000 members** reached through our various platforms in the past year.

"Harrison's Hope is a lighthouse for families navigating the FASD storm. Together, we are transforming despair into hope and isolation into community."

Sub Header:

Media Kit

About Harrison's Hope
Harrison's Hope is a non-profit organization founded on the principle of lifelong support for individuals and families living with FASD. Harrison's Hope recognizes the need for a continuum of services that starts with prevention, education and extends to senior care, fostering inclusion and inter-dependence.

For more information visit harrisonshope.ca

Media Contact:
Mary Byrnes
Harrison's Hope

Tel: 426-301-4430
Email: mary@harrisonshope.ca

Sub Header:

Podcast *coming soon

Caregiver Testimonials (to be used as you have currently set up as a sliding view)

1. "I cannot thank the team from Harrison's Hope enough! We still can't believe that we finally have our son's identification placement and his IEP! Once Harrison's Hope entered the picture and began advocating for J, the school team finally started listening." — **Caregiver J.**
2. "Thank you for such a great time yesterday! The boys and I really enjoyed ourselves. You put your whole self into it, and it shows! I think the boys really connected." — **Caregiver M.**

3. "A big thank you for the Starbucks gift cards that were given out as prizes—Alex is one happy bowler! We truly appreciate the thoughtfulness and the excellent event today." — **Caregiver S.**

4. "I thought I knew a lot about FASD until I joined your Caregiver Support Group. I have never felt so safe and immediately at home with a group of strangers. They've become the extended family I wished I had." — **Caregiver D.**

5. "Thank you for another great virtual guest speaker. My husband and I both loved Nate. We look forward to seeing who the speaker is every month—please keep this program running!" — **Caregiver E.**

6. "Mary, you have no idea how much I appreciate you. It makes a huge difference knowing Harrison's Hope is there. We were so isolated before; now we have connections with families who truly 'get it.'" — **Caregiver L.**
7. "Before Harrison's Hope, we felt like we were fighting the school board alone. You helped the team see FASD as a disability rather than a 'bad attitude.' You changed our son's future." — **Caregiver T.**

8. "The virtual events have been a lifeline. Hearing from adults living with FASD has given us so much hope for our daughter's future. Each story is so unique and inspiring." — **Caregiver R**

9. "Harrison's Hope doesn't just support the child; they support the whole family. Knowing your team is available to us both at home and at school takes a weight off our shoulders." — **Caregiver J.**

10. "I've attended many workshops, but yours was the first that felt like it was built on lived experience. It's practical, research-backed, and filled with so much heart." — **Caregiver B.**

11. "The isolation of being an FASD caregiver is real. Harrison's Hope disrupted that pattern for us and created a 'pocket of wellness' in our lives that we didn't know was possible." — **Caregiver H.**

12. "Thank you for helping us navigate the system. Without your service navigation and advocacy, we would still be lost in the paperwork. You are improving the lives of so many." — **Caregiver A.**

13. "Our son finally feels understood. The way you advocate for FASD-informed lenses in the community has made the world a little friendlier for him." — **Caregiver G.**

Service Provider & Agency Testimonials

14. "We simply cannot get over how much we really didn't know about daily life with FASD. Your workshop was engaging and informative. We can't wait for our next session with your team!" — **Agency P.**

15. "Thank you for the wonderful webinar. We have received so much positive feedback from caregivers! I've already recommended your website and virtual events to my entire caseload." — **Agency A**

16. "Your presentations invite people to want to do better and be better for those living with this disability. One of your webinars had the highest attendance we've ever seen. Let's plan more for the New Year!" — **Agency C.**

17. "It was incredible to meet you in person at the conference. I was so impressed with your passionate compassion and your incredible knowledge to help families navigate an FASD diagnosis." — **Agency S.**
18. "Harrison's Hope provides the perfect blend of current research knowledge and lived experience. It's precisely what our Education Liaisons need to better support children within the child welfare system." — **Service Provider, E.**

19. "The feedback from our staff has been incredible. Both caregivers and providers had so many 'ah-ha' moments during your session. You really connect with your audience." — **Agency L**

20. "We value our collaborations with Harrison's Hope. Your team has a real talent for helping others learn how to practice from an FASD-informed lens with simple, effective accommodations." — **Agency M.**

21. "Thank you for the wonderful information! I'm hoping to rearrange my schedule to join every guest speaker event you have. The resources you provide are invaluable." — **Agency J.**

22. "Harrison's Hope is a leader in establishing local FASD support networks. Their commitment to evidence-based practices and community engagement is creating meaningful change in Ontario and beyond." — **Regional Coordinator.**

23. "The 'Red Shoes Rock' for FASD Awareness community walk and free FASD Conference and Family Fun Day have done more for local FASD awareness than any campaign we've seen. You are making the invisible visible." — **Community Partner.**

24. "Mary and Lisa bring a level of expertise that is rare. They don't just teach the research; they share their caregiver and lived experiences to show you how to apply it to improve the lives of neurodivergent individuals every day." — **Clinical Consultant.**

25. "Working with Harrison's Hope has helped our agency bridge the gap between diagnosis and daily support. Their FASD advocacy in the anti-human trafficking system is second to none." — **Agency Director.**